

LESSON SIX

CHURCH

Understanding God's Heart for His Church

ACTS 242 FOUNDATION GUIDE · EDITION 1 · 2026

LESSON 6 OF 7

To gain a deeper understanding of how God values His Church and His wonderful plans for her, and to know how we must function as part of God's household.

MAIN QUESTION

**When you hear the word
Church, what comes
into your mind?**

Many people think of church as a building, a service, or a religious gathering. But in Scripture, the Church is far more than that. The Church is God's people, Christ's body, God's family, and the bride of Christ.

To understand the Church rightly is to understand how God wants us to live, love, serve, and remain faithful to Him.

How do you truly view the Church?

Before we open the Bible

When you hear the word Church, what comes into your mind?

Write the first three things, not the correct answer, the honest one.

What has your experience of church been so far?

Jesus Is the Head

COLOSSIANS 1:15–18 NIV

¹⁵ The Son is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn over all creation. ¹⁶ For in him all things were created: things in heaven and on earth, visible and invisible, whether thrones or powers or rulers or authorities; all things have been created through him and for him. ¹⁷ He is before all things, and in him all things hold together. ¹⁸ And he is the head of the body, the church; he is the beginning and the firstborn from among the dead, so that in everything he might have the supremacy.

The Church belongs to Jesus. He leads it, sustains it, and gives it purpose.

If Jesus is the Head, then the Church must submit to Him. We do not define the Church by personal preference, culture, or convenience. We understand the Church through Christ.

The Body of Christ

1 CORINTHIANS 12:12–14 NIV

¹² Just as a body, though one, has many parts, but all its many parts form one body, so it is with Christ. ¹³ For we were all baptized by one Spirit so as to form one body—whether Jews or Gentiles, slave or free—and we were all given the one Spirit to drink. ¹⁴ Even so the body is not made up of one part but of many.

To be part of the Church means:

- belonging to Christ
- being connected to His people
- living under His authority

Are you connected to the body, or only near it?

Every Part Belongs

1 CORINTHIANS 12:15–22 NIV

VERSES 15 TO 18

¹⁵ Now if the foot should say, “Because I am not a hand, I do not belong to the body,” it would not for that reason stop being part of the body. ¹⁶ And if the ear should say, “Because I am not an eye, I do not belong to the body,” it would not for that reason stop being part of the body. ¹⁷ If the whole body were an eye, where would the sense of hearing be? If the whole body were an ear, where would the sense of smell be? ¹⁸ But in fact God has placed the parts in the body, every one of them, just as he wanted them to be.

Every Part Belongs, continued

1 CORINTHIANS 12:15–22 NIV

VERSES 19 TO 22

¹⁹ If they were all one part, where would the body be? ²⁰ As it is, there are many parts, but one body. ²¹ The eye cannot say to the hand, “I don’t need you!” And the head cannot say to the feet, “I don’t need you!” ²² On the contrary, those parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable,

UNDERSTAND

God did not design the Church so that one person does everything and everyone else watches.

Each believer has a place, a value, and a function. Some may be more visible, while others serve quietly. But every part matters.

No Division in the Body

1 CORINTHIANS 12:23–28 NIV

²³ and the parts that we think are less honorable we treat with special honor. And the parts that are unpresentable are treated with special modesty, ²⁴ while our presentable parts need no special treatment. But God has put the body together, giving greater honor to the parts that lacked it, ²⁵ so that there should be no division in the body, but that its parts should have equal concern for each other. ²⁶ If one part suffers, every part suffers with it; if one part is honored, every part rejoices with it. ²⁷ Now you are the body of Christ, and each one of you is a part of it. ²⁸ And God has placed in the church first of all apostles, second prophets, third teachers, then miracles, then gifts of healing, of helping, of guidance, and of different kinds of tongues.

UNDERSTAND

The Church becomes unhealthy when people compare, compete, or withdraw.

The Church becomes strong when each member accepts their role and serves faithfully.

**Where there is pride,
division grows. Where
there is love, the body is
strengthened.**

How We Treat One Another

JOHN 13:34–35 NIV

³⁴ “A new command I give you: Love one another. As I have loved you, so you must love one another. ³⁵ By this everyone will know that you are my disciples, if you love one another.”

The Church is not held together merely by attendance, activity, or structure. It is held together by love, unity, and service. To function as the Church means:

- serving one another
- caring for one another
- honoring one another
- loving one another as Christ loved us

ASK

Name one person in the church you will serve this month, and how.

Members of His Household

EPHESIANS 2:19–22 NIV

¹⁹ Consequently, you are no longer foreigners and strangers, but fellow citizens with God's people and also members of his household, ²⁰ built on the foundation of the apostles and prophets, with Christ Jesus himself as the chief cornerstone. ²¹ In him the whole building is joined together and rises to become a holy temple in the Lord. ²² And in him you too are being built together to become a dwelling in which God lives by his Spirit.

The Church is not only an organization. It is a family. In God's family, there should be:

— belonging — support — growth — accountability — shared life in Christ

The Bride of Christ

EPHESIANS 5:25–27 NIV

²⁵ Husbands, love your wives, just as Christ loved the church and gave himself up for her ²⁶ to make her holy, cleansing her by the washing with water through the word, ²⁷ and to present her to himself as a radiant church, without stain or wrinkle or any other blemish, but holy and blameless.

REVELATION 19:6–7 NIV

⁶ Then I heard what sounded like a great multitude, like the roar of rushing waters and like loud peals of thunder, shouting:

“Hallelujah!

For our Lord God Almighty reigns.

⁷ Let us rejoice and be glad

and give him glory!

For the wedding of the Lamb has come,
and his bride has made herself ready.

ACTS 242 SUMMARY

As a church, we are the Bride of Christ. Christ loved the church and gave himself up for her, to make her holy and to present her to himself radiant. At the wedding of the Lamb, His bride has made herself ready.

This shows how precious the Church is to Jesus. He loves her, cares for her, and is preparing her. If the Church is the Bride of Christ, then faithfulness matters: keeping Christ first, rejecting compromise, pursuing holiness, remaining faithful to Him.

1 CORINTHIANS 11:2-4 NIV

² I praise you for remembering me in everything and for holding to the traditions just as I passed them on to you. ³ But I want you to realize that the head of every man is Christ, and the head of the woman is man, and the head of Christ is God. ⁴ Every man who prays or prophesies with his head covered dishonors his head.

ACTS 24:2 SUMMARY

Christ over man, man over woman, and God over Christ. He also says that a man who prays or prophesies with his head covered dishonors his head.

The Hope of the Church

JOHN 14:1-3 NIV

¹ “Do not let your hearts be troubled. You believe in God; believe also in me. ² My Father’s house has many rooms; if that were not so, would I have told you that I am going there to prepare a place for you? ³ And if I go and prepare a place for you, I will come back and take you to be with me that you also may be where I am.

We Will Be With the Lord

1 THESSALONIANS 4:16–18 NIV

¹⁶ For the Lord himself will come down from heaven, with a loud command, with the voice of the archangel and with the trumpet call of God, and the dead in Christ will rise first. ¹⁷ After that, we who are still alive and are left will be caught up together with them in the clouds to meet the Lord in the air. And so we will be with the Lord forever. ¹⁸ Therefore encourage one another with these words.

UNDERSTAND

The Church does not live only for the present. We live with hope. Jesus has not forgotten His people.

This gives believers comfort in suffering, faithfulness in waiting, confidence in God's promises, and hope beyond this world.

KEY TRUTH

**The Church is not
abandoned. The
Church is awaited.**

Answer Honestly

How do I truly view the Church?

Do I see the Church as Christ's body, God's family, and the Bride of Christ?

Am I functioning faithfully as part of the body?

Do I serve, love, and protect the unity of the Church?

Am I remaining faithful to Christ?

CHALLENGE

- 01 Value the Church the way God values the Church.
- 02 Refuse division.
- 03 Love other believers.
- 04 Use your gifts to serve.
- 05 Stay faithful to Christ.
- 06 Live with the hope of His return.

PRAYER

Lord,

Thank You for Your Church. Teach me to value what You value.

Help me to love Your people, serve faithfully, protect unity,
and remain true to Christ. Let my life strengthen Your body
and honor You.

Amen.

N E X T

Lesson 7

Cross

Learning to hate sin and love God through Jesus' sacrifice